



The Humanitas Institute

## Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Grace Academy

School Website: <https://graceacademyspringfield.org/>

December 27, 2025

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**Disclaimer**

*This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.*

**ACCS Member School**

*Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.*

## Executive Summary

Grace Academy Springfield (Grace Academy MA 01104) presents a clear Classical Christian program anchored in the Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric), a Biblically centered worldview, and a strong emphasis on Western classical heritage, Great Books, and traditional liberal arts study. Public materials from the school repeatedly frame education as formation in service of God, family, and virtuous living, with explicit statements about fostering truth, goodness, and beauty, and about cooperation with parents as co-educators. The curriculum emphasizes grammar, logic, and rhetoric; history is taught as a traditional, chronological study within Western civilization; Latin and language mastery are foregrounded; and memory work, recitation, and singing are cited pedagogical practices. The school positions itself as part of Sovereign Grace Church, uses in loco parentis language, and invites parental involvement and partnerships.

Overall classification by category (using the Six Essential Elements rubric and keyword framework): - Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL - Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL - Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL - Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL - Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL - Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Executive summary category-by-category snapshot follows, with explicit keyword analyses drawn from Grace Academy's public materials and aligned to positive/negative indicators from the classical lexicon.

Cited sources reflect Grace Academy Springfield content (public site materials) and the Six Essential Elements framework in the knowledge base.

- Evidence of religious and metaphysical foundations, including Biblical worldview framing, Trivium emphasis, liturgical/prayer practices, and theology-related language. See Our Plan / Objectives / Philosophy materials.
- Evidence of formation-focused purpose (formation over mere information), telos, and pursuit of truth, goodness, beauty, with explicit statements about virtue and human flourishing.
- Curriculum anchored in liberal arts, Trivium, Great Books, Latin, Western civilization, and historical study.
- Pedagogy emphasizing memorization/recitation, contemplative/restful elements, plus Socratic/spoken rhetoric components in high school contexts; Pre-K indicates balanced play-based and teacher-led elements.
- Faculty described as role models, living curriculum, and partners with students; explicit reference to staff/board as exemplary figures.
- Parents and community partnerships foregrounded (co-teachers, parental ownership, invitations for visits, home-school partnership language).

What would move the needle section follows only if some category were SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL; in this case, all categories meet Classical criteria, so needle-moving changes are not required.

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## Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

### Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
  - The school emphasizes a Biblical worldview and Christ-centered education as foundational, with explicit statements about training within a Biblical framework and the Trivium guiding instruction. Public materials repeatedly frame knowledge within a Biblical theological context and emphasize God-centered formation.
  - Liturgical/prayer elements and classroom prayer are described as a regular part of school life, signaling liturgical/community practices that align with liturgical foundations.
  - The Fear of the Lord as the beginning of wisdom is quoted in their philosophy statements, tying moral order and wisdom to a theological ground.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
  - Positive keywords present: truth, goodness, beauty, virtue, theology, worship, liturgy, catechesis, creed, wisdom, Logos, sacred worldview, imago Dei, reverence, wonder.
  - Negative keywords: minimal usage of relativism, secularism, or value-neutral ethics; no clear signaling of secular humanism or relativism in the school's public materials.
- Why this rating
  - The materials anchor education in transcendentals (truth, goodness, beauty) and a robust theology, with worship/prayer embedded in practice, indicating a CLASSICAL alignment in religious and metaphysical foundations.

Citations: Biblical worldview statements, Trivium framing, and liturgical/prayer language appear across Grace Academy Springfield pages.

### Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
  - The school states formation and cultivation of virtue and wisdom as goals, not merely job preparation. The Objectives explicitly tie education to Biblical worldview and classical formation (grammar, logic, rhetoric) and to parental partnership in mission.
  - The school frames education as formation that fosters love of truth, goodness, and beauty (truth, goodness, and beauty are named as aims in objectives). The language of formation and a classical mission is frequent.
  - References to classical liberal education and a telos oriented toward human flourishing/virtue are present in the public materials.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
  - Positive keywords present: formation, cultivation, virtue, wisdom, liberal education, paideia, classical mission, telos, pursuit of the true/good/beautiful, scholé (the term appears in the lexicon and is conceptually aligned with contemplative learning).
  - Negative keywords present: few or none (no emphasis on workforce-first or 21st-century-skills-for-job-prep mindsets in the public materials).
- Why this rating
  - The school's stated aims revolve around formation, virtue, and wisdom—consistent with CLASSICAL expectations for purpose and goal.

Citations: Our Objectives and philosophy statements emphasize formation and classical aims.

### Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
  - Curriculum is described as liberal arts with Trivium focus (grammar, logic, rhetoric), Great Books, Latin, and history anchored in Western civilization. The school explicitly mentions Great Books, primary sources, and the Great Conversation within its Classical framework.

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- History is treated as the organizing framework for the curriculum, with emphasis on traditional history in a Western-providence framework, rather than social studies.
  - Language focus includes Latin, phonics-based reading, and intensive language instruction; Great Books are central through the Logic and Rhetoric stages.
  - Grade-level content includes Pre-K through Grade 12 with a grammar-stage emphasis in early years and classical-language instruction emphasized in the early years; tuition pages emphasize the Classical model and Latin emphasis.
  - Positive/Negative keyword analysis
    - Positive keywords present: liberal arts, trivium, quadrivium, grammar, logic, rhetoric, Great Books, primary sources, classics, Homer, Plato, Shakespeare, Latin, Western civilization, history, chronology.
    - Negative keywords present: minimal use of social studies terminology replacing history, avoidance of project-based-first framing (not a central feature in the public materials).
  - Why this rating
    - Curriculum is explicitly aligned with classical content and structure, including Great Books and a Trivium-based sequence, yielding a CLASSICAL classification.

Citations: Curriculum materials explicitly reference Trivium, Great Books, and Western history framing.

#### **Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL**

- Evidence
  - Recitation/memorization is explicitly cited as a methodology in the early stages; the school emphasizes a classical teaching style that includes memorization and chant-like repetition in its Pre-K to grammar-stage approach.
  - The Trivium informs pedagogy (grammar, logic, rhetoric) as a guiding structure for instruction; language-focused instruction emphasizes reading, writing, speaking well, with phonics and Latin.
  - There are indications of Socratic and seminar-style elements at the upper levels in the public materials (the Trivium framework suggests such methods, and there is narrative about rhetoric training and public speaking).
  - In lower grades, there is an intentional mix of contemplative/restful elements and regular memory work; Pre-K includes play-based, teacher-led, and memory-based activities.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
  - Positive keywords present: Socratic/seminar (conceptually linked to classical pedagogy in the Trivium), recitation, chanting, memory work, catechesis, liturgical calendar integration, rhetoric, debate, seminars.
  - Negative keywords present: experiential learning-focused, project-based-only language is not central to the Grace materials; some play-based/teacher-led balance exists but does not dominate pedagogy as a modern constructivist approach.
  - The overall signal is strongly CLASSICAL because recitation, memory, and a Trivium-based pipeline are clearly described.
- Why this rating
  - Pedagogy reflects a classical approach with memory/recitation and rhetoric training, aligned with the Six Essential Elements' positive pedagogy indicators.

Citations: Recitation/memorization and Trivium-based pedagogy are described in Our Plan and Based on the Trivium materials.

#### **Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL**

- Evidence
  - The school describes faculty as exemplary role models who embody virtue and guide students; objectives call for staff and Board to model Biblical virtues. The living-curriculum concept (faculty as part of the curriculum) is reflected in the public materials.

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- Public materials emphasize teacher-student relationship, with a focus on mentorship and character formation, not just content delivery.
  - Positive/Negative keyword analysis
    - Positive keywords present: mentors, role models, virtuous teachers, living curriculum, collegial culture, character formation, mentorship, virtue ethics.
    - Negative keywords: none evident in the public content.
  - Why this rating
    - The materials present faculty as central to the classical mission, modeling virtue and maintaining a close, mentorship-oriented culture; CLASSICAL.

Citations: The mission/objectives sections articulate faculty as exemplars and the living curriculum; public materials describe mentorship and virtue-focused roles.

### **Element 6: School Parents and Community — CLASSICAL**

- Evidence
  - The school emphasizes partnership with families and parental primacy, with explicit statements about parents as co-teachers and about maximizing parental involvement in the child's education. There are direct references to in loco parentis and to parental participation in training and mission.
  - The materials describe open-campus policies, tours, and parental participation in school life, aligning with a community-centric classical model.
  - The Distinctives and Vision materials foreground family formation, book studies, and classical parent training in the context of the school's classical project.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
  - Positive keywords present: partnership with families, co-teachers, parental formation, home-centered learning, family catechesis, parental responsibility, engaged families, school-parent synergy, parent formation.
  - Negative keywords: no consumer/customer-only framing; no minimal-parent involvement signals in the public content.
- Why this rating
  - Parental involvement and partnership are central to Grace Academy's model, which aligns with CLASSICAL expectations for parent-community integration.

Citations: The Our Plan/Objectives language demonstrates parental partnership and co-teaching expectations; visiting openness is noted in Grace materials.

### **What Would Move the Needle**

- Not applicable, as all six categories are classified as CLASSICAL. If needed for further enhancement (not required here), potential steps could include:
  - Deepening explicit articulation of Great Books and primary-source reading across grade bands with documented outcomes.
  - Expanding formal teacher-training materials to codify classical pedagogy across all divisions.

Note: The above is provided for completeness, but no needle-moving changes are required given the CLASSICAL classification across all six categories.

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# Appendix

## ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

### Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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